MC 501 Definitions Practice rubric

25 points. Due Monday, October 19, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 25. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Attempts are unlimited, so you can revise an early submission right up to the deadline.

- Each row looks across all of your variables. Four variables done fully is the assignment.

Definitions Practice, 25 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Conceptual definition, with its source 3 points	**3 points.** Every variable says what it means in the abstract and cites where the idea comes from; an idea you invented gets a sentence defending it.	**2 points.** Defined for every variable, but a citation is missing, or an invented idea goes undefended.	**1 point.** Some definitions missing, or definitions that list examples instead of saying what the variable captures.	**0 points.** Missing.
Operational definition 6 points	**6 points.** Every variable says exactly what a coder does to assign a value, with an action a coder performs, clear enough that a stranger could follow it and reach your answer.	**5 points.** A procedure for every variable, but one leaves a step to the coder's judgment.	**3 to 4 points.** At least one repeats the conceptual definition in other words, the mistake this assignment exists to catch. If it has no action a coder performs, it is not an operational definition yet.	**0 to 2 points.** No procedures.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Level of measurement, and what it allows 3 points	**3 points.** Named for every variable, with one sentence on what it allows and rules out in analysis (for example, no mean of a nominal variable).	**2 points.** Named for every variable, but the sentence on what it allows is missing or wrong for one.	**1 point.** Named for some variables only.	**0 points.** Missing.
Coded values 3 points	**3 points.** Every value is listed with what it means, and every item fits exactly one value.	**2 points.** Listed with meanings, but there is no place for items that fit none of them, or two values overlap.	**1 point.** Values listed without meanings, or the list trails off ("etc.").	**0 points.** Missing.
Edge-case decision rules 5 points	**5 points.** At least two per variable, each a rule a coder can apply, drawn from cases that come up in your material.	**4 points.** Two per variable, but one is an intention ("be careful with sarcasm") instead of a rule.	**3 points.** Fewer than two for some variables.	**0 to 2 points.** None, or intentions only.
Validity sentence 5 points	**5 points.** One sentence per variable naming what would make you doubt it measures the idea in its conceptual definition, specific to that variable.	**4 points.** Present for every variable, but the same general sentence is reused.	**3 points.** Present for some variables only.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.

Before you submit

Codebook Check reads a pasted definition block and reports which variables are missing a conceptual or an operational definition, a level of measurement, or a catch-all category. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.